

ANXIETY & STRESS MANAGEMENT WORKBOOK

**A Complete CBT-Based System for Understanding,
Managing, and Overcoming Anxiety**

By Daniel Tesfamariam

Evidence-based tools, worksheets, and tracking systems
to help you regain control of your mental wellness.

Copyright 2024 Daniel Tesfamariam. All rights reserved.
This workbook is for educational purposes only and is not a substitute
for professional mental health treatment.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Chapter 1: Understanding Anxiety	3
Chapter 2: CBT Thought Records & Worksheets	11
Chapter 3: Breathing & Grounding Techniques	23
Chapter 4: Worry Management System	31
Chapter 5: 30-Day Anxiety Tracker	41
Chapter 6: Coping Strategies Toolkit	53
Chapter 7: Safety Planning	61
Chapter 8: Action Plans & Goals	65
Final: Next Steps & Resources	73

CHAPTER 1: UNDERSTANDING ANXIETY

What Is Anxiety?

Anxiety is your body's natural response to perceived threats or danger. It is a complex combination of physical sensations, thoughts, and behaviors that evolved to protect us from harm. While some anxiety is normal and even helpful, excessive or chronic anxiety can interfere with daily life, relationships, work performance, and overall well-being.

Understanding anxiety is the first step toward managing it effectively. When you understand what is happening in your brain and body during an anxiety response, you gain the power to intervene and redirect that response in healthier ways.

The Anxiety Cycle

Anxiety operates in a predictable cycle that reinforces itself over time. Understanding this cycle gives you multiple intervention points where you can break the pattern:

- TRIGGER: An event, thought, or sensation that activates anxiety
- THOUGHT: An interpretation of the trigger (often catastrophic or distorted)
- PHYSICAL RESPONSE: Body sensations like racing heart, sweating, tension
- EMOTIONAL RESPONSE: Feelings of fear, dread, panic, or overwhelm
- BEHAVIORAL RESPONSE: Avoidance, escape, reassurance-seeking, or safety behaviors
- REINFORCEMENT: Short-term relief from avoidance strengthens the anxiety cycle

Each time you avoid something that triggers anxiety, your brain learns that the trigger is genuinely dangerous. This makes the anxiety stronger next time. Breaking this cycle requires gradually facing fears while using coping strategies to manage discomfort.

Types of Anxiety Disorders

While this workbook addresses general anxiety management skills, it helps to understand the different presentations anxiety can take:

Generalized Anxiety Disorder (GAD)

Characterized by excessive, uncontrollable worry about multiple areas of life including work, health, family, money, and everyday matters. People with GAD often describe feeling worried most of the time and find it difficult to relax or stop their mind from racing.

Social Anxiety Disorder

Intense fear of social situations where you might be judged, embarrassed, or rejected. This can range from specific fears like public speaking to generalized discomfort in most social interactions.

Panic Disorder

Recurrent unexpected panic attacks followed by persistent worry about having more attacks. Panic attacks involve sudden surges of intense fear with physical symptoms like chest pain, shortness of breath, and feeling like you are dying.

Specific Phobias

Intense, irrational fear of specific objects or situations such as heights, flying, animals, blood, or enclosed spaces. The fear is out of proportion to the actual danger posed.

Health Anxiety

Preoccupation with having or developing a serious illness. Involves frequent body checking, excessive research about symptoms, repeated doctor visits, or avoidance of health-related information.

Physical Symptoms of Anxiety

Anxiety is not just in your head. It produces real, measurable physical changes throughout your body. These symptoms occur because your sympathetic nervous system activates the fight-or-flight response:

- Rapid heartbeat or heart palpitations
- Shortness of breath or feeling like you cannot get enough air
- Chest tightness or chest pain
- Muscle tension, especially in neck, shoulders, and jaw
- Stomach problems: nausea, butterflies, IBS symptoms
- Sweating, especially palms, underarms, and forehead
- Trembling or shaking
- Dizziness or lightheadedness
- Tingling or numbness in hands and feet
- Dry mouth and difficulty swallowing
- Headaches and migraines
- Fatigue and exhaustion despite adequate sleep
- Insomnia or restless sleep
- Frequent urination
- Hot flashes or chills

Your Anxiety Self-Assessment

Rate each item below from 0 (not at all) to 4 (nearly every day) over the past two weeks:

- ___ Feeling nervous, anxious, or on edge
- ___ Not being able to stop or control worrying
- ___ Worrying too much about different things
- ___ Trouble relaxing

- ☐ Being so restless that it is hard to sit still
- ☐ Becoming easily annoyed or irritable
- ☐ Feeling afraid as if something awful might happen
- ☐ Difficulty concentrating on tasks
- ☐ Sleep difficulties (falling or staying asleep)
- ☐ Physical tension that will not go away

TOTAL SCORE: _____ / 40

Scoring: 0-7 Minimal | 8-15 Mild | 16-25 Moderate | 26-40 Severe

My Anxiety Profile Worksheet

Take time to map your personal anxiety patterns:

My top 3 anxiety triggers:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

My most common anxious thoughts:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

My primary physical symptoms:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

My typical avoidance behaviors:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Things that make my anxiety worse:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Things that help my anxiety improve:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 1

- [] Complete the anxiety self-assessment above

- ☐ Fill out your anxiety profile worksheet
- ☐ Identify your top 3 triggers for the coming week
- ☐ Notice which physical symptoms you experience most
- ☐ Write down one situation you have been avoiding due to anxiety
- ☐ Share your anxiety score with a trusted person or therapist

CHAPTER 2: CBT THOUGHT RECORDS & WORKSHEETS

Introduction to Cognitive Behavioral Therapy

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT) is the gold standard treatment for anxiety disorders. It is based on the principle that our thoughts, feelings, and behaviors are all interconnected. By changing the way we think about situations, we can change how we feel and what we do.

The CBT model shows that it is not situations themselves that cause anxiety, but rather our interpretation of those situations. Two people can face the exact same situation and have completely different emotional responses because they interpret the situation differently.

Thought records are the cornerstone tool of CBT. They help you identify, examine, and restructure the automatic negative thoughts that fuel your anxiety. With regular practice, you will develop the ability to catch distorted thoughts in real-time and replace them with more balanced perspectives.

Common Cognitive Distortions

These are thinking patterns that seem true but actually distort reality in anxiety-provoking ways:

1. Catastrophizing

Assuming the worst possible outcome will definitely happen. Example: A headache means you have a brain tumor. Being late to work means you will be fired.

2. All-or-Nothing Thinking

Seeing things in black and white with no middle ground. If something is not perfect, it is a complete failure. Example: If you make one mistake in a presentation, the entire thing was terrible.

3. Mind Reading

Assuming you know what others are thinking, usually that they are judging you negatively. Example: They did not text back because they think I am annoying.

4. Fortune Telling

Predicting negative outcomes with certainty before they happen. Example: I just know this interview is going to go badly.

5. Emotional Reasoning

Believing something is true because you feel it strongly. Example: I feel like a failure, so I must be one.

6. Should Statements

Rigid rules about how you, others, or the world should be. Example: I should never make mistakes. People should always be on time.

7. Overgeneralization

Taking one negative event and applying it to all situations. Example: One bad date means you will never find love.

8. Magnification and Minimization

Blowing negative things out of proportion while shrinking positives. Example: Focusing on one piece of critical feedback while ignoring ten compliments.

9. Personalization

Taking responsibility for things that are not your fault. Example: My friend canceled plans, so it must be because of something I did wrong.

10. Filtering

Focusing exclusively on negative details while filtering out all positive aspects of a situation.

How to Complete a Thought Record

Follow these steps each time you notice anxiety rising:

- Step 1: Identify the SITUATION - What happened? Where were you? Who was there?
- Step 2: Record your EMOTIONS - What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%
- Step 3: Capture AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS - What went through your mind?
- Step 4: Find the COGNITIVE DISTORTION - Which thinking error applies?
- Step 5: Challenge the thought with EVIDENCE FOR and AGAINST
- Step 6: Create a BALANCED THOUGHT - A more realistic alternative
- Step 7: RE-RATE your emotions - How do you feel now? 0-100%

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #1

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading

☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements

☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #2

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

- ☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading
☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements
☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #3

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading

☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements

☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #4

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

- ☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading
☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements
☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #5

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading

☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements

☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #6

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading

☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements

☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #7

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading

☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements

☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #8

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading

☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements

☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #9

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading

☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements

☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

THOUGHT RECORD WORKSHEET #10

Date: _____ Time: _____

SITUATION (What happened? Where? Who? When?)

EMOTIONS (What did you feel? Rate intensity 0-100%)

Emotion 1: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ Intensity: _____ %

AUTOMATIC THOUGHTS (What went through your mind?)

COGNITIVE DISTORTION (Which thinking error?)

☐ Catastrophizing ☐ All-or-Nothing ☐ Mind Reading

☐ Fortune Telling ☐ Emotional Reasoning ☐ Should Statements

☐ Overgeneralization ☐ Magnification ☐ Personalization

EVIDENCE FOR this thought:

EVIDENCE AGAINST this thought:

BALANCED THOUGHT (More realistic alternative)

RE-RATE EMOTIONS after completing this record:

Emotion 1: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 2: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

Emotion 3: _____ New Intensity: _____ %

What did I learn from this exercise?

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 2

-
- ☐ Complete at least one thought record per day for one week
 - ☐ Identify your top 3 most common cognitive distortions
 - ☐ Practice catching automatic thoughts as they happen
 - ☐ Review completed thought records weekly to find patterns
 - ☐ Share a thought record with your therapist or support person

CHAPTER 3: BREATHING & GROUNDING TECHNIQUES

Why Breathing Matters

When anxiety activates your fight-or-flight response, one of the first things that changes is your breathing pattern. You begin to breathe faster and shallower, taking in more oxygen than your body needs. This hyperventilation actually makes anxiety symptoms worse by causing dizziness, tingling, and chest tightness.

Controlled breathing is the fastest way to activate your parasympathetic nervous system, which is responsible for the relaxation response. By deliberately slowing and deepening your breath, you send a signal to your brain that says you are safe, and your body begins to calm down within minutes.

Technique 1: 4-7-8 Breathing

This technique was developed by Dr. Andrew Weil and is one of the most effective methods for rapid anxiety relief. It works by extending your exhale, which stimulates the vagus nerve.

Instructions:

- Sit comfortably with your back straight
- Place the tip of your tongue against the ridge behind your upper front teeth
- Exhale completely through your mouth, making a whoosh sound
- Close your mouth and INHALE quietly through your nose for 4 counts
- HOLD your breath for 7 counts
- EXHALE completely through your mouth for 8 counts (whoosh sound)
- This is one complete breath cycle
- Repeat for 4 full cycles (work up to 8 cycles over time)

Practice Schedule: Do this exercise twice daily - once in the morning and once before bed. Also use it any time you feel anxiety rising.

My 4-7-8 Practice Log:

Day 1 - Morning: ____ Evening: ____ Anxiety Level Before/After: ____/____
Day 2 - Morning: ____ Evening: ____ Anxiety Level Before/After: ____/____
Day 3 - Morning: ____ Evening: ____ Anxiety Level Before/After: ____/____
Day 4 - Morning: ____ Evening: ____ Anxiety Level Before/After: ____/____
Day 5 - Morning: ____ Evening: ____ Anxiety Level Before/After: ____/____
Day 6 - Morning: ____ Evening: ____ Anxiety Level Before/After: ____/____
Day 7 - Morning: ____ Evening: ____ Anxiety Level Before/After: ____/____

Technique 2: Box Breathing (Navy SEAL Method)

Used by Navy SEALs to remain calm under extreme pressure. This technique is excellent for acute anxiety or panic situations because of its simplicity and effectiveness.

Instructions:

- Visualize a square or box in your mind
- INHALE for 4 counts (trace up the left side of the box)
- HOLD for 4 counts (trace across the top)
- EXHALE for 4 counts (trace down the right side)
- HOLD for 4 counts (trace across the bottom)
- Repeat for 5-10 minutes or until calm

Technique 3: Diaphragmatic (Belly) Breathing

Most anxious people breathe into their chest. Diaphragmatic breathing engages the belly, activating deeper relaxation and better oxygen exchange.

Instructions:

- Lie down or sit comfortably
- Place one hand on your chest and one on your belly
- Breathe in slowly through your nose for 4 counts
- Your belly should rise while your chest stays relatively still
- Exhale slowly through pursed lips for 6 counts
- Feel your belly fall back down
- Practice for 5-10 minutes, twice daily

Grounding Technique 1: The 5-4-3-2-1 Method

This powerful technique works by redirecting your attention from anxious thoughts to your immediate physical environment. It engages all five senses to anchor you in the present moment.

Instructions:

When you feel anxiety rising or a panic attack beginning, work through these steps:

5 THINGS I CAN SEE:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

4 THINGS I CAN TOUCH/FEEL:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

3 THINGS I CAN HEAR:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

2 THINGS I CAN SMELL:

1. _____
2. _____

1 THING I CAN TASTE:

1. _____

Grounding Technique 2: Progressive Muscle Relaxation

PMR works by systematically tensing and then releasing muscle groups throughout your body. This teaches you to recognize the difference between tension and relaxation, and releases stored physical anxiety.

Full Body PMR Script (15-20 minutes):

For each muscle group: Tense for 5 seconds, then release for 15 seconds. Notice the contrast between tension and relaxation.

- FEET: Curl your toes tightly... hold... release and notice the relaxation
- CALVES: Point your toes up toward shins... hold... release
- THIGHS: Squeeze your thigh muscles... hold... release
- BUTTOCKS: Clench your glutes... hold... release
- STOMACH: Tighten your abdominal muscles... hold... release
- CHEST: Take a deep breath and hold... hold... exhale and release
- HANDS: Make tight fists... hold... release and spread fingers
- FOREARMS: Flex your wrists back... hold... release
- BICEPS: Curl your arms up tightly... hold... release
- SHOULDERS: Shrug shoulders up to ears... hold... release and drop
- NECK: Gently press head back... hold... release
- FACE: Scrunch all facial muscles... hold... release
- FOREHEAD: Raise eyebrows high... hold... release

After completing all muscle groups, take 3 deep breaths and notice how your entire body feels different from when you started.

Grounding Technique 3: Cold Water Reset

The diving reflex is a powerful physiological response that immediately slows your heart rate and calms your nervous system. It works by triggering the vagus nerve through temperature change.

Methods:

- Hold ice cubes in your hands for 30-60 seconds
- Splash very cold water on your face and wrists
- Hold a cold pack against your forehead or back of neck
- Submerge your face briefly in a bowl of cold water

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 3

- ☐ Practice 4-7-8 breathing twice daily for one week
- ☐ Try box breathing during your next stressful moment
- ☐ Complete the 5-4-3-2-1 grounding exercise above
- ☐ Do progressive muscle relaxation before bed tonight
- ☐ Keep ice cubes accessible for the cold water reset technique
- ☐ Rate which technique works best for you personally

CHAPTER 4: WORRY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

Understanding Worry

Worry is a cognitive process where your mind repeatedly cycles through potential negative outcomes. Unlike productive problem-solving, worry does not lead to solutions. Instead, it keeps you trapped in a loop of what if scenarios that increase anxiety without resolving anything.

Research shows that 85% of things people worry about never actually happen. Of the 15% that do occur, 79% of people report handling the situation better than they expected. This means that 97% of what you worry about is either unlikely to happen or more manageable than you think.

The key is not to eliminate worry entirely, which is impossible, but to contain it, evaluate it, and redirect your mental energy toward things you can actually control.

The Worry Decision Tree

When you notice yourself worrying, ask these questions in order:

Step 1: Is this worry about something I can control?

YES -> Go to Step 2

NO -> Practice acceptance. Use grounding. Let it go.

Step 2: Can I take action on this RIGHT NOW?

YES -> Take one small action immediately

NO -> Schedule it in your worry time. Write it down. Move on.

Step 3: What is the smallest possible action I can take?

Write it here: _____

When will I do it? _____

Scheduled Worry Time

One of the most effective worry management strategies is to designate a specific time and place for worrying. Outside of this window, you postpone all worries to your scheduled time.

How to implement:

- Choose a 15-20 minute window each day (not before bed)
- Choose a specific location (not your bedroom)
- When worries arise outside this time, write them down and postpone
- During worry time, worry intentionally about your list
- When the timer ends, close your worry list and move on

My Scheduled Worry Time: _____ to _____

My Worry Location: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 1

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 2

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 3

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 4

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 5

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 6

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 7

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 8

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 9

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

WORRY JOURNAL - Page 10

Date: _____

Worry #1

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #2

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

Worry #3

What am I worried about? _____

Likelihood (0-100%): _____%

Can I control this? ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Partially

Worst case scenario: _____

Best case scenario: _____

Most likely scenario: _____

One action I can take: _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 4

-
- ☐ Set up your scheduled worry time starting today
 - ☐ Use the worry decision tree for every worry this week
 - ☐ Complete at least 3 worry journal pages
 - ☐ Track how many of your worries actually come true
 - ☐ Practice postponing worries to your designated worry time
 - ☐ Identify your top 3 recurring worry themes

CHAPTER 5: 30-DAY ANXIETY TRACKER

How to Use This Tracker

Tracking your anxiety daily serves multiple important purposes. It helps you identify patterns in when and why your anxiety increases or decreases. It shows you the connection between your habits and your anxiety levels. And it provides concrete evidence of your progress over time.

Each day, fill in the following information. Try to complete it at the same time each day, ideally in the evening as you reflect on your day.

Rating Scale:

- 1 = Minimal anxiety, felt calm and in control most of the day
- 2 = Mild anxiety, some worry but manageable
- 3 = Moderate anxiety, noticeable impact on daily activities
- 4 = High anxiety, significant difficulty functioning normally
- 5 = Severe anxiety, overwhelming, possibly panic attacks

DAY 1

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 2

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 3

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 4

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 5

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

WEEK 1 CHECK-IN (Days 1-5)

Average anxiety this week (1-5): ____

Most common trigger: _____

Most helpful coping strategy: _____

Improvement from last week? ☐ Yes ☐ Same ☐ Worse

Goal for next week: _____

DAY 6

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

DAY 7

Date: ____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

DAY 8

Date: ____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

DAY 9

Date: ____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

DAY 10

Date: ____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

WEEK 2 CHECK-IN (Days 6-10)

Average anxiety this week (1-5): ____
Most common trigger: ____
Most helpful coping strategy: ____
Improvement from last week? ☐ Yes ☐ Same ☐ Worse
Goal for next week: ____

DAY 11

Date: ____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

DAY 12

Date: ____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

DAY 13

Date: ____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

DAY 14

Date: ____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

DAY 15

Date: ____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: ____
Coping Strategy Used: ____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: ____

WEEK 3 CHECK-IN (Days 11-15)

Average anxiety this week (1-5): ____
Most common trigger: ____
Most helpful coping strategy: ____
Improvement from last week? ☐ Yes ☐ Same ☐ Worse
Goal for next week: ____

DAY 16

Date: ____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____
Coping Strategy Used: _____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 17

Date: _____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: _____
Coping Strategy Used: _____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 18

Date: _____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: _____
Coping Strategy Used: _____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 19

Date: _____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: _____
Coping Strategy Used: _____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 20

Date: _____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____
Coping Strategy Used: _____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

WEEK 4 CHECK-IN (Days 16-20)

Average anxiety this week (1-5): ____
Most common trigger: _____
Most helpful coping strategy: _____
Improvement from last week? ☐ Yes ☐ Same ☐ Worse
Goal for next week: _____

DAY 21

Date: _____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: _____
Coping Strategy Used: _____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 22

Date: _____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: _____
Coping Strategy Used: _____
Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No
Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 23

Date: _____
Anxiety Level (1-5): ____
Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____
Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____
Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____
Main Trigger Today: _____
Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 24

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 25

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

WEEK 5 CHECK-IN (Days 21-25)

Average anxiety this week (1-5): ____

Most common trigger: _____

Most helpful coping strategy: _____

Improvement from last week? ☐ Yes ☐ Same ☐ Worse

Goal for next week: _____

DAY 26

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 27

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 28

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 29

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

DAY 30

Date: _____

Anxiety Level (1-5): ____

Hours of Sleep Last Night: ____

Exercise Today? ☐ Yes ☐ No Minutes: ____

Caffeine Intake: ____ Alcohol: ____

Main Trigger Today: _____

Coping Strategy Used: _____

Did it help? ☐ Yes ☐ Somewhat ☐ No

Gratitude - One good thing today: _____

WEEK 6 CHECK-IN (Days 26-30)

Average anxiety this week (1-5): ____

Most common trigger: _____

Most helpful coping strategy: _____

Improvement from last week? ☐ Yes ☐ Same ☐ Worse

Goal for next week: _____

30-DAY SUMMARY & REFLECTION

Overall average anxiety level: ____

Lowest anxiety day: Day ____ (Level: ____)

Highest anxiety day: Day ____ (Level: ____)

Top 3 triggers identified:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Most effective coping strategies:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Patterns I noticed (sleep, exercise, diet connections):

What I learned about my anxiety:

My plan going forward:

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 5

- [] Commit to tracking daily for the full 30 days
- [] Set a daily reminder to complete your tracker entry
- [] Review your weekly check-ins each Sunday
- [] Complete the 30-day summary after finishing
- [] Share progress with your accountability partner

CHAPTER 6: COPING STRATEGIES TOOLKIT

Having a diverse toolkit of coping strategies is essential because different situations call for different approaches. What works during a panic attack is different from what helps with chronic background worry. Build your personal toolkit by trying each strategy and noting which ones work best for you.

CATEGORY 1: Physical Strategies (Body-Based)

- 1. Go for a brisk 10-minute walk outside
- 2. Do 20 jumping jacks or burpees to burn off adrenaline
- 3. Take a cold shower or splash cold water on your face
- 4. Stretch your neck, shoulders, and back for 5 minutes
- 5. Practice progressive muscle relaxation from head to toe
- 6. Dance to your favorite upbeat song for 3 minutes
- 7. Do yoga or gentle stretching for 15 minutes
- 8. Squeeze a stress ball or fidget toy
- 9. Hug someone or a pillow tightly for 20 seconds
- 10. Chew gum or eat something crunchy mindfully

CATEGORY 2: Mental Strategies (Thought-Based)

- 11. Name your anxiety as a character (Hello, Worry Monster)
- 12. Count backward from 100 by 7s
- 13. Name 5 countries, 5 animals, 5 colors in your head
- 14. Visualize your safe place in vivid detail
- 15. Repeat a calming mantra: This feeling is temporary
- 16. Challenge the thought: What evidence supports this?
- 17. Ask: Will this matter in 5 years? 5 months? 5 weeks?
- 18. Imagine advising a friend with the same worry
- 19. Rate your anxiety 1-10 and check back in 10 minutes
- 20. Write the worry down and physically put it away

CATEGORY 3: Sensory Strategies (Five Senses)

- 21. Light a scented candle or use essential oils (lavender)
- 22. Listen to calming music or nature sounds
- 23. Look at photos that make you feel happy and safe
- 24. Wrap yourself in a weighted blanket or heavy comforter
- 25. Drink herbal tea slowly, noticing temperature and flavor
- 26. Take a warm bath with epsom salts
- 27. Pet an animal and focus on the texture of their fur
- 28. Eat dark chocolate slowly, savoring each bite

- 29. Hold something cold (ice cube) and focus on the sensation
- 30. Run your hands under warm water for 2 minutes

CATEGORY 4: Social Strategies (Connection-Based)

- 31. Call or text a supportive friend
- 32. Tell someone: I am feeling anxious right now
- 33. Attend a support group meeting (online or in-person)
- 34. Write a letter to someone you appreciate
- 35. Do something kind for a stranger
- 36. Play with children or pets
- 37. Join an online community for anxiety support
- 38. Ask for a hug from someone safe
- 39. Volunteer for a cause you believe in
- 40. Share your experience in a journal or blog

CATEGORY 5: Creative Strategies (Expression-Based)

- 41. Draw, paint, or color in an adult coloring book
- 42. Write freely in a journal for 10 minutes without stopping
- 43. Play a musical instrument
- 44. Sing loudly to your favorite song
- 45. Build something with your hands (origami, crafts, Legos)
- 46. Take photographs of beautiful things around you
- 47. Write a poem or short story about your feelings
- 48. Cook or bake something new
- 49. Garden or tend to houseplants
- 50. Rearrange or organize a small space

My Personal Top 10 Coping Strategies

After trying the strategies above, record your top 10 most effective ones here for quick reference during anxious moments:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 6

- ☐ Try at least 2 strategies from each category this week
- ☐ Rate each strategy effectiveness (1-10) after trying it
- ☐ Fill in your Personal Top 10 list
- ☐ Write your top 3 on an index card to carry with you
- ☐ Teach one strategy to someone else

CHAPTER 7: SAFETY PLANNING

A safety plan is a personalized, practical plan that you create in advance for times when anxiety becomes overwhelming. Having a written plan means you do not have to think clearly during a crisis because you have already decided what to do.

MY PERSONAL SAFETY PLAN

Step 1: Warning Signs That My Anxiety Is Escalating

Physical signs: _____
Thought patterns: _____
Behavioral changes: _____
Emotional shifts: _____

Step 2: Internal Coping Strategies (Things I Can Do Alone)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Step 3: People Who Can Help Distract Me

Name: _____ Phone: _____
Name: _____ Phone: _____
Name: _____ Phone: _____

Step 4: People I Can Ask for Help

Name: _____ Phone: _____
Name: _____ Phone: _____
Therapist: _____ Phone: _____

Step 5: Professional Resources

My therapist: _____ Phone: _____
My doctor: _____ Phone: _____
Crisis line: 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline)
Crisis text: Text HOME to 741741
Emergency: 911

Step 6: Making My Environment Safe

Things I can do to make my surroundings feel safer:

Step 7: My Reasons for Getting Through This

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 7

-
- ☐ Complete your full safety plan above
 - ☐ Share your safety plan with a trusted person
 - ☐ Save crisis numbers in your phone
 - ☐ Take a photo of this plan to keep on your phone
 - ☐ Review and update your plan monthly

CHAPTER 8: ACTION PLANS & GOALS

Setting Meaningful Anxiety Recovery Goals

Recovery from anxiety is not about eliminating all anxiety forever. It is about building the skills and confidence to manage anxiety effectively so it no longer controls your life. Setting specific, measurable goals gives you a roadmap and allows you to track your progress.

Use the SMART framework for your goals: Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound.

My 30-Day Goals

Goal 1: _____

How I will measure it: _____

Target date: _____

Goal 2: _____

How I will measure it: _____

Target date: _____

Goal 3: _____

How I will measure it: _____

Target date: _____

My 90-Day Goals

Goal 1: _____

How I will measure it: _____

Target date: _____

Goal 2: _____

How I will measure it: _____

Target date: _____

Goal 3: _____

How I will measure it: _____

Target date: _____

Exposure Hierarchy (Fear Ladder)

List situations that cause anxiety from least (1) to most (10) feared. Start practicing exposure with the lowest items and work your way up as each level becomes manageable:

10 (Most feared): _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

9. _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

8. _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

7. _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

6. _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

5. _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

4. _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

3. _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

2. _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

1 (Least feared): _____

Date attempted: _____ Anxiety before: ____ After: ____ Completed? ____

Weekly Progress Check-In Template

Week 1 Check-In

Date: _____

Average anxiety this week (1-10): ____

Thought records completed: ____

Breathing exercises practiced: ____

Exposures attempted: ____

Biggest win this week: _____

Biggest challenge: _____

Goal for next week: _____

Week 2 Check-In

Date: _____

Average anxiety this week (1-10): ____

Thought records completed: ____

Breathing exercises practiced: ____

Exposures attempted: ____
Biggest win this week: ____
Biggest challenge: ____
Goal for next week: ____

Week 3 Check-In

Date: ____
Average anxiety this week (1-10): ____
Thought records completed: ____
Breathing exercises practiced: ____
Exposures attempted: ____
Biggest win this week: ____
Biggest challenge: ____
Goal for next week: ____

Week 4 Check-In

Date: ____
Average anxiety this week (1-10): ____
Thought records completed: ____
Breathing exercises practiced: ____
Exposures attempted: ____
Biggest win this week: ____
Biggest challenge: ____
Goal for next week: ____

Week 5 Check-In

Date: ____
Average anxiety this week (1-10): ____
Thought records completed: ____
Breathing exercises practiced: ____
Exposures attempted: ____
Biggest win this week: ____
Biggest challenge: ____
Goal for next week: ____

Week 6 Check-In

Date: ____
Average anxiety this week (1-10): ____
Thought records completed: ____
Breathing exercises practiced: ____
Exposures attempted: ____
Biggest win this week: ____
Biggest challenge: ____
Goal for next week: ____

Week 7 Check-In

Date: _____

Average anxiety this week (1-10): ____

Thought records completed: ____

Breathing exercises practiced: ____

Exposures attempted: ____

Biggest win this week: _____

Biggest challenge: _____

Goal for next week: _____

Week 8 Check-In

Date: _____

Average anxiety this week (1-10): ____

Thought records completed: ____

Breathing exercises practiced: ____

Exposures attempted: ____

Biggest win this week: _____

Biggest challenge: _____

Goal for next week: _____

YOUR ACTION ITEMS - Chapter 8

-
- [] Set 3 SMART goals for the next 30 days
 - [] Complete your fear ladder / exposure hierarchy
 - [] Attempt the lowest item on your fear ladder this week
 - [] Schedule weekly check-ins with yourself
 - [] Celebrate every small step of progress

NEXT STEPS & RESOURCES

Congratulations on completing this workbook. By working through these chapters, you have built a comprehensive toolkit for managing anxiety. Remember that recovery is not linear. There will be good days and harder days, and that is completely normal.

Your Ongoing Practice Plan

- Continue daily breathing exercises (5 minutes minimum)
- Complete thought records whenever anxiety is moderate or higher
- Use your worry journal during scheduled worry time
- Track anxiety daily for at least 90 days total
- Work through your exposure hierarchy at your own pace
- Review and update your safety plan monthly
- Check in with your weekly progress template

When to Seek Professional Help

This workbook is a supplement to, not a replacement for, professional treatment. Please seek help from a licensed therapist or counselor if:

- Your anxiety significantly impacts work, relationships, or daily functioning
- You experience frequent panic attacks
- You are using substances to cope with anxiety
- You have thoughts of self-harm
- Your anxiety has not improved after 4-6 weeks of consistent practice

By Daniel Tesfamariam

You are stronger than your anxiety. Keep going.